

entire cost of a more elaborate bed frame. Throw on a bed skirt and toss up a hanging tapestry or some sort of DIY headboard.

DIY Linen Spray

While I love the idea of having a freshening spray for bed linens, curtains, and pillows, I don't see any reason to pay big bucks for this stuff. Pick up a spray bottle, add water, rubbing alcohol, and scented oil of your choice to create your own version of this product.

Custom Candle Containers

The super-large designer candles aren't cheap, and if you like to enjoy candles in your personal space as much as we do, they can be expensive to keep replacing. Create your own luminaries using tea lights and votive holders. Get a few reasonably large clear containers and fill with something decorative and affordable, such as beach sand and shells, glass beads, river rocks, or potpourri. Arrange the smaller glass votive holders inside the larger container. They will be supported by the filler you choose. Go nuts with your tea lights (which you can buy in bulk from places like Ikea).

THE BATHROOM

Multipurpose Dish Soap

You don't need to spend extra just to get a bottle labeled "toilet bowl cleaner" with a fancy nozzle to clean your toilet—that's what the brush is for. By switching from various different cleaning products to dish soap only, you can buy the dish soap in bulk, saving more per bottle.

Refillable Containers

One way I keep my sanity is to have certain things we use regularly at every single workstation where I might need them. For example, with lotions I like one by the kitchen sink, every bathroom sink, and a couple of other places like by the couch where I read and next to my side of the bed. While I'm definitely a buy-in-bulk girl, dishing out for that many giant bottles of lotion is simply unnecessary, not to mention space-hogging. Keep products in small containers around the house where you use them, and refill when necessary.

Multipurpose Shampoo

Like dish soap, shampoo is not a one-purpose item. In addition to its primary use, I use it as a shower gel, detergent for hand-washing delicate items, gentle face cleanser, bubble